

Lab: Listening to What Wants to Happen

Objective

Explore embodied planning through movement lab that reveals how the body anticipates, prepares for, and evaluates future action through the lens of dance, yoga, martial arts.

Prerequisites

- A quiet, comfortable space for 25 minutes
- Willingness to engage in movement lab
- No prior experience required

Part 1: Arriving (5 minutes)

Stand in a comfortable position. Shake out your hands and feet gently. Roll your shoulders. Take three breaths. Begin to sway gently, finding your body's natural rhythm of movement.

Notice: your body is already planning. It is adjusting posture, regulating breath, and anticipating what comes next. Through dance, yoga, martial arts, attend to the body's forward-looking quality.

Write your response here

(What is your body preparing for right now? What future does it seem to anticipate?)

Part 2: Felt Futures (7 minutes)

Think of two possible activities. For each, let the body simulate the experience. Through dance, yoga, martial arts, notice the somatic response -- does the body lean toward one future or pull away?

Write your response here

(Describe the bodily response to each imagined future. Did the body have a preference? How did dance, yoga, martial arts inform this evaluation?)

Part 3: Emergent Action (7 minutes)

Rather than planning what to do next, ask the body: What wants to happen? Wait. Let a movement or action emerge without deliberation. Through dance, yoga, martial arts, trust the body's intelligence.

Write your response here

(What emerged? Was there a sense of rightness or flow? How does dance, yoga, martial arts support or challenge this kind of emergent planning?)

Part 4: Reflection (5 minutes)

Through dance, yoga, martial arts, reflect on the relationship between planning and presence.

Write your response here

(Can you plan without projecting anxiously into the future? How does embodied planning through dance, yoga, martial arts differ from intellectual planning?)

Reflection Table

Dimension	What I Noticed	Active Inference Connection
Initial awareness		Baseline generative model state
Embodied exploration		Prediction error through direct experience
Dance, yoga, martial arts lens		Course-specific perspective on planning
Integration		Updated understanding through bodily knowing

Discussion

Consider how dance, yoga, martial arts reveals aspects of planning that other perspectives might miss. In Active Inference, every perspective changes the precision weighting of different signals, revealing different dimensions of the same underlying process of free energy minimization.